

\# Centre-Back Scouting Case Study

\\# Finding a Replacement Profile for Marc Guéhi

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\# Objective

This project identifies statistically similar centre-back profiles using UEFA Euro 2024 performance data.

The objective:

Identify potential replacement profiles for Marc Guéhi based on defensive and possession metrics.

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\# Dataset

Competition:

UEFA Euro 2024

Data source:

StatsBomb Open Data

Sample:

\- 51 matches analysed

\- 108 centre-backs identified

\- Minimum threshold: 270 minutes played

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\# Methodology

Players were compared using:

\## Defensive metrics

\- Tackles per 90

\- Interceptions per 90

\- Clearances per 90

\## Possession metrics

\- Pass completion percentage

\- Progressive passes per 90

A similarity model was created using normalised statistical distance.

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\# Target Player

\## Marc Guéhi

Team:

England

Position:

Centre-back

Profile:

\- Reliable defender

\- Strong positioning

\- Secure passer

\- Comfortable progressing possession

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\# Closest Statistical Matches

The model identified the following profiles:

1\. Robin Le Normand — Spain

2\. Jan Vertonghen — Belgium

3\. Riccardo Calafiori — Italy

4\. Wout Faes — Belgium

5\. Jonathan Tah — Germany

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\# Player Assessment

\## Robin Le Normand

Strengths:

\- Similar defensive output

\- Strong passing reliability

\- Experienced positioning

Fit:

Closest overall statistical profile.

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\## Riccardo Calafiori

Strengths:

\- Progressive passing

\- Ball progression

\- Tactical flexibility

Fit:

Higher-upside modern centre-back profile.

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\# Key Findings

The analysis suggests that replacement profiles for Marc Guéhi should combine:

- \- Defensive consistency

- \- Passing security

- \- Progressive ability

- \- Tactical adaptability

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\# Limitations

The model does not include:

\- Aerial duel quality

\- Defensive context

\- Opposition strength

\- Tracking data

\- Tactical role differences

The output should support scouting decisions rather than replace expert judgement.

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\# Conclusion

Data analysis can identify comparable player profiles and support recruitment decisions.

The strongest candidates combine defensive reliability with modern possession ability.

